

Pre-Meeting Briefing — Water Birth Protocol R2

To	Dr. Henrik Olsson and the senior midwives group
From	Helen Newton, on behalf of the water birth protocol working group
Meeting	Department-head final approval, November 27, 2026
Distribution	Working group and senior midwives only. Not for wider circulation before the meeting.

Purpose

You are being asked to walk into the November 27, 2026 approval meeting having already seen the shape of what is being proposed, so nobody is meeting the change for the first time in the room. The full submission dossier is available in the shared working-group workspace. This briefing is the two-minute version, plus an honest read on the questions we expect from you and how the working group thinks about each.

Two-minute read of the change

VGR-DEL-WB-2026-R2 changes two things and clarifies a third. Everything else is unchanged from R1.

- **Water temperature range in the second stage** narrows from 36.5 to 38.0 °C to 36.8 to 37.5 °C. Aligns with 2024–2025 literature and current European practice consensus.
- **Primiparous second-stage escalation threshold** is clarified at 90 minutes. R1 was silent on this and the ward defaulted variably between 60 and 90 minutes in practice. This is a clarification, not a relaxation.
- **Pool hygiene reference** is updated to the 2025 European infection control consensus. Documentation change only, no clinical change.

Eligibility, exclusion criteria, escalation pathway, postpartum handover, and documentation cadence all remain as in R1.

Protocol delta — VGR-DEL-WB-2023-R1 -> VGR-DEL-WB-2026-R2

Two clinical parameters changed. One documentation reference updated. Everything else unchanged.

Parameter	R1 (current)	R2 (proposed)	Rationale / evidence
Water temperature range (2nd stage)	36.5 - 38.0 °C	36.8 - 37.5 °C	EL-0117, EL-0121 (2024 cohorts), EL-0134 (2025 review). Confidence: mod-high.
Primiparous 2nd-stage escalation	silent (defaulted 60 min)	90 min	EL-0104, EL-0122, EL-0135. Clarification, not relaxation. Confidence: moderate.
Pool hygiene reference	Hospital SOP 2019	2025 European consensus	EL-0130. Documentation change only.
Eligibility criteria	as in R1	unchanged	No change.
Exclusion criteria	as in R1	unchanged	No change.
Escalation pathway to obstetrics	as in R1	unchanged	No change.
Postpartum handover	as in R1	unchanged	No change.
Documentation cadence	as in R1	unchanged	No change.

Amber bar = changed parameter. Everything else is unchanged from R1.
Full delta table with evidence-log references: 02_protocol_draft.md Section 9.

R1 to R2 delta at a glance. Amber bar marks a changed parameter.

Questions we expect from you and colleagues

On neonatal outcomes beyond 28 days

The evidence is thin. We are not claiming a benefit. We are carrying it as a monitored gap in the risk register and reviewing it at the two-year cycle. If you want us to sharpen the audit design, please say so before we submit.

On the narrower temperature range and correction frequency

We expect a modest increase in the number of documented temperature corrections during the second stage. This is not a safety concern, and Module 2 in the training rollout covers the correction workflow. If your read is that this increases documentation load beyond what the ward can absorb, we would rather hear it now than after go-live.

On the primiparous 90-minute clarification

We are proposing an audit cycle from April 6, 2027 through October 6, 2027 to confirm second-stage durations sit within the intended distribution. We think this is the right posture. Your read matters more than ours here.

Helen's honest read on each

Neonatal outcomes beyond 28 days. We are being conservative on purpose. Anyone who wants a stronger claim in the protocol will not get it from me, and I would rather lose that argument than overreach.

Temperature range. The evidence is strong enough to change this. The correction-frequency concern is real but manageable.

Primiparous clarification. This is closing a real gap in R1 language, not opening a new door.

What we are not asking you to bless yet

- The bank and pool staff pathway. Out of scope for this approval. We are drafting it separately for a post go-live rollout.
- The downstream updates to GL-OB-2019-08 clause 4.2 and GL-OB-2021-14 clause 6.1. Guideline maintainers' work post approval. We are flagging them, not owning them.
- The training rollout final rota. Draft only. Malin will finalise it after approval.

If any of the above lands wrong for you, please come back before November 25, 2026 so we can adjust the room posture rather than the room itself.

Working group: Helen Newton (lead), Malin Eriksson (team lead), Frida Holm (equipment lead), Dr. Henrik Olsson (obstetrics advisor).

Reference dossier: [helen-newton_Artifacts/submission_dossier/](#). Distribution controlled by Helen Newton.